

July

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## Born this day

**1961 Diana Spencer**, Princess of Wales, a member of the British royal family. Known as the “people’s princess”, she supported many charitable causes.

**1971 Missy Elliott**, Black American rapper. One of the most successful female rappers, she is best known for hit singles such as *Get Ur Freak On* and *Work It*.

1912

## Gender bender

Popular actor and male impersonator Vesta Tilley appeared on stage dressed as a man during a royal performance at the Palace Theatre in London, UK. The watching Queen Mary was so shocked to see a woman’s legs that she covered her face.



## Tour de France

1903

The first stage of this long-distance bicycle race began in Paris, France. The Tour de France became an annual event, and the most famous cycling race in the world.

1867

## Canada united

The Constitution Act united the British colonies of Canada, Nova Scotia, and New Brunswick into the self-governing Dominion of Canada. The day is now celebrated as Canada Day to commemorate this step towards full independence.

## Also on this day

**1908** The Morse code **SOS** officially became a global distress signal and began to be used by ships in danger.

**1968** The **Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons** was signed by 62 countries to stop the spread of nuclear weapons.

**1997** After more than a century of British rule, Hong Kong was returned to China.